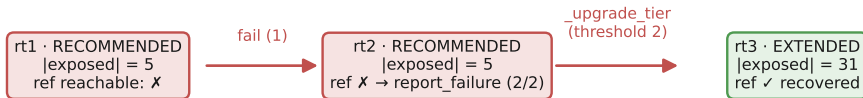


Query: "what time is it now" (ref = datetime_tool)

BEFORE (merge off):



2 failed round-trips + 1 escalation → ≈8.3 s added latency (measured)

AFTER (merge on):



0 failed round-trips · 0 escalations · 0 added latency · ref merged in place (|set| 5 →6 vs detour to 31)